(a) Easy: compress safely

Q: Worst thing to do while driving?

$\gamma = 0.5$	$\gamma = 1.0$
✓ correct 141 tokens	✓ correct 307 tokens

Insight: Same answer, fewer tokens.

Suffice → $\gamma = 0.5$

(b) Hard: preserve the budget

Q: Which building do many citizens enter?

$\gamma = 0.5$	$\gamma = 1.0$
✗ wrong 134 tokens	✓ correct 302 tokens

Insight: Compression can break the answer.

Suffice → $\gamma = 1.0$

(c) Non-monotone: more can hurt

Q: George wants to go home; tired of what?

$\gamma = 0.5$	$\gamma = 1.0$
✓ correct 187 tokens	✗ wrong 266 tokens

Insight: More reasoning, wrong answer.

Suffice → $\gamma = 0.5$

Keep predicted sufficiency > full reasoning; choose minimum predicted tokens.

Suffice: allocate before decoding

Read prefix → **Gate + choose cost** → Decode once